These problems could be contained if a Hindu Rashtra were established.

The critics of Hindu Rashtra, Upadhyaya argued, found that the term was inexpedient for them in the country's competitive politics: they were afraid of losing millions of Christian and Muslim voters. Their misconception was that the use of the term 'Hindu Rashtra' excluded Muslim and Christian communities. If both these communities became one with the national cultural mainstream—without any change in their modes of worship—they would be welcome in the new India. All they had to do was to own up to the ancient traditions of India, to look upon Hindu national heroes as their national heroes, and to develop devotion for Bharat Mata. Then they would be fully accepted as nationals of the Hindu Rashtra.

In affirming this view of India's political identity, Upadhyaya was in effect returning to the Savarkar-Golwalkar home base: his political inclusiveness was illusory, for the terms in which it was formulated, despite the seeming openness to other forms of religious worship, left no room for anything but submission to Hindu dominance. However, to be fair, in other aspects of his political philosophy, especially in relation to the economic needs of the underclasses, Upadhyaya demonstrated a more substantive inclusiveness.

Rather like Gandhi, Upadhyaya believed in *swaraj* ('self-governance'), visualising for India a decentralised polity and self-reliant economy centered on its villages. But there was a more profound consequence of this approach. He eschewed the label of socialism, but expelled seven of the nine MLAs his Jan Sangh party had in Rajasthan for opposing the Zamindari (big landowner) Abolition Act piloted by the Congress to cut large landholdings down to size in the name of socialism. Individual freedom in a democratic system, he argued, enabled the rich to monopolise production, gain economic power and influence government machinery. Upadhyaya deplored the fact that Indian villagers had lost their jobs to large factories. Socialism, he said, was an understandable response to the exploitation of the masses in the industrial age.